

because you feel obliged to but can't actually afford to. You could extend this out to situations where you feel that you have to say yes to costly commitments, or to buy something for your children because they're nagging you, or to condone unhealthy spending behaviour from a partner because you don't want them to feel that you're judging or controlling them. Can you think of times when this applies to you, or has applied in the past? Think about all of your different relationships, both professional and personal, and make sure that you consider the other resources that can have a knock-on effect to your financial health, such as time, energy and mental capacity. Are there any relationships where you have found yourself growing resentful? Are there any people who you feel consistently ignore your boundaries?

Next, ask yourself whether you feel that you have clearly and fairly communicated those boundaries to the other person in your relationship. It could be that you have, and that the other person is ignoring or pushing back against your boundaries, in which case they need to be restated and followed through on. Speaking from experience, often when we're feeling particularly frustrated we tell ourselves or the other person that we're not going to do something again – like lending money that isn't paid back, or working an hour's unpaid overtime – but the other person assumes that it's said in the heat of the moment, and they expect the same, unboundaried behaviour from you the next time that the situation arises. This can feel like your good nature is being taken advantage of, and it